

Anand Mathew

PhD Candidate in Economics
University of Florida

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Last updated October 2026

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA, PhD in Economics	2022 – May 2027 (expected)
Advisor: Ignacia Mercadal	
SOUTH ASIAN UNIVERSITY, New Delhi, Master of Economics (Development Economics)	2020
ST. STEPHEN'S COLLEGE, University of Delhi, BA (Hons) in Economics	2018

FIELDS

Primary: Development Economics, Household Finance
Secondary: Environmental Economics, Applied Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Credit Where Credit Is Withdrawn: Weather Shocks and the Household Coping Portfolio in India
with Sankalp Mathur (CAFRAL)

Weather shocks cut income in India, and household consumption barely moves. The null has been found often enough to look like a fact about insurance. We argue it is a fact about the outcome variable. Total spending does not respond because households change what they buy rather than how much, and a regression on the level looks for a change in scale that never occurs. In a panel of 210,942 Indian households observed from 2014 to 2019 and matched to 1.08 billion loan records from the credit bureau, spending cuts begin with the postponable, from entertainment and restaurant meals down through clothing, and stop before cereals, which do not fall at all. The September 2018 default of Infrastructure Leasing and Financial Services, a funding shock that bound hardest in districts reliant on non-bank lenders, then lets us ask what formal credit contributes. Where the lender withdrew, the same weather shock pushes households further along the ordering, into health, education, and staples such as milk, none of which move where credit held. Displaced borrowers mostly do not resurface at moneylenders. More stop borrowing altogether than switch, so losing formal access looks closer to rationing than redirection. Availability of credit does not stop a weather shock from being felt. It determines how far down the coping portfolio a household has to go.

WORKING PAPERS

Cannabis Access and College Persistence: Evidence from Washington State's Dispensary Lottery

This paper examines how proximity to recreational marijuana dispensaries affects postsecondary educational outcomes in Washington State. Leveraging the quasi-random placement of dispensaries via a state-run license lottery and a staggered difference-in-differences framework, I estimate the causal impact of dispensary access on college enrollment and retention rates. Using campus-level administrative data from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS) and detailed dispensary location data, I find that institutions located within a 10-minute driving radius of a dispensary experienced a statistically

significant 7.9 percentage point decline in student retention rates. In contrast, there is no evidence that dispensary proximity affects college enrollment. Robustness checks across alternative distance thresholds confirm that the retention effect is stable and significant for thresholds between 10 and 15 minutes, while enrollment results remain null.

PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association, 96th Annual Meeting, Houston (scheduled)	Nov 2026
World Inequality Conference, Paris School of Economics	Jun 2026
Southern Economic Association, 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa	Nov 2025
WATE-Florida Workshop	Oct 2025
Discussant WATE-Florida Workshop, "Student Debt and Aggregate Consumption: Does Inequality Matter?"	Oct 2025

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Madelyn Lockhart Doctoral Student Travel Award, University of Florida (three awards)	2025, 2026
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of Florida ECO 4421 Econometrics (undergraduate)	Fall 2025, Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant, University of Florida ECO 5435 Economic Data Analysis (graduate), for Hector Sandoval	Spring 2026
ECO 4504 Public Economics, for Steven Slutsky	Spring 2026
ECP 5702 Managerial Economics (graduate), for Thomas Knight	Summer 2025
ECO 2023 Principles of Microeconomics, for Mark Rush	Summer 2025
ECO 4421 Econometrics, for Jay Lee	Spring 2025
ECO 3430 Economic Analysis of Data, for Ignacia Mercadal	Fall 2024
ECO 4400 Game Theory and Applications, for Fatma Gunay	Summer 2024
ECO 3203 Intermediate Macroeconomics, for Min Fang	Fall 2023
ECO 5464 Game Theory and Industrial Organization (graduate), for Germán Bet	Fall 2022, 2023
ECO 4400 Game Theory and Applications, for Richard Romano	Spring 2023
ECO 6409 Game Theory Applied to Business Decisions (graduate), for Richard Romano	Fall 2022

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Douglas Turner, University of Florida	Summer 2026
Research Assistant to Scott Kostyshak, University of Florida	Spring 2024
Research Assistant to Gunnar Heins and Ignacia Mercadal, University of Florida	Summer 2023
Research Assistant, Schumacher Centre Society, New Delhi	2020 – 2022
Research Intern, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, Government of India	2019 – 2020
Survey Coordinator, National Food Security Act survey led by Jean Drèze and Reetika Khera	2016

DATA, COMPUTING AND LANGUAGES

Data: CMIE Consumer Pyramids Household Survey, TransUnion CIBIL credit bureau records (accessed through CAFRAL), SPEIbase climate data, Periodic Labour Force Survey, IPEDS, Washington State Liquor and Cannabis Board licensing and tax records

Software: R, Stata, L^AT_EX, HiPerGator high-performance computing, Google Maps geocoding and distance APIs

Languages: English, Hindi

REFERENCES

Ignacia Mercadal (Advisor)
Assistant Professor of Economics
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